HOW ARE THE OTHER CHALLENGERS PLACED?

Political parties other than the BJP and Congress have significant electoral influence in 11 states, occupying the state government in nine of them. These states account for 366 Lok Sabha seats; yet only 145, or less than 40 per cent, seats were cornered by non-BJP, non-Congress parties in the 2019 general election. The challenge for these parties will be to improve their scores in their respective areas of influence if they want to see a non-BJP government at the Centre in 2024



ARVIND KEJRIWAL
AAP
Delhi
70 18.2%
Punjab
131 7.5%
No alliance



MAMATA BANERJEE
TMC
West Bengal
42 22 43.7%
Used to be in the UPA, but is now playing solo



M.K. STALIN
DMK
Tamil Nadu
39 24 33.5%
Is in alliance with the Congress



AKHILESH YADAV
SP
Uttar Pradesh
80 5 18.1%



MAYAWATI
BSP
Uttar Pradesh
80 10 19.4%

The two were in alliance last time, but broke up after the election



NITISH KUMAR
JD(U)
Bihar
40 16 22.3%



TEJASHWI YADAV
RJD
Bihar
40 0 15.7%

Both are in alliance with the Congress now; in 2019, JD(U) was with the BJP



Y.S. JAGAN MOHAN REDDY
YSRCP
Andhra Pradesh
25 22 49.9%
No alliance



K. CHANDRA-SHEKAR RAO
TRS
Telangana
17 9 41.7%
No alliance



UDDHAV THACKERAY
Shiv Sena
Maharashtra
48 18 23.5%
Was with the BJP, then joined the Congress and NCP, now solo



SHARAD PAWAR
NCP
Maharashtra
48 4 15.7%
In alliance with the Congress



NAVEEN PATNAIK
BJD
Odisha
21 12 42.8%
No alliance



PINARAYI VIJAYAN
CPI(M)
Kerala
20 1 26%
Part of the LDF coalition



HEMANT SOREN
JMM
Jharkhand
14 1 11.7%
With Congress and RJD

● Total Lok Sabha seats
● Lok Sabha seats won in 2019
● Vote share

Source: ECI

If non-BJP parties, therefore, have any hope of mounting a credible opposition to the BJP in 2024, they first have to devise an effective seat-sharing mechanism. One challenge to the saffron party could come from Bihar, where the revival of the *mahagathbandhan* or grand alliance comprising Janata Dal (United), Rashtriya Janata Dal and Congress that succeeded against the BJP in the 2015 assembly poll, could dent the BJP's tally in the state, which has 40 seats up for grabs. Bihar chief minister and JD(U) chief Nitish Kumar is projected as a possible prime ministerial candidate against Modi. But first he has to earn the trust of other Opposi-

AMONG THE OTHER ACES UP ITS SLEEVE FOR 2024, THERE WILL BE THE COMPLETED RAM TEMPLE IN AYODHYA, AS WELL AS THE UNIFORM CIVIL CODE